



Targeting or
segmenting
customers
can increase
revenues by
as much as
760%

Data & Marketing Association, 2014

BRINGING CUSTOMERS TO LIFE

To understand potential customers, it helps to picture them as characters or “avatars”. Some simple research techniques can be used to compile detailed customer habits and interests.

- › **Study competitors’** social media pages for insights into customer opinions and behaviors. Compile any customer contact details.
- › **Read trade or industry blogs** and articles and note customer-related comments and insights.
- › **Identify key influencers** who have a connection to your product or service area, and note the views of those who follow them.
- › **Make a template** for your avatars, giving them an identity and filling in personal details based on the four main areas (see below).
- › **Consider the characters** who are unlikely to be your customers. That way, you avoid wasting time on marketing to the wrong people.

PSYCHOGRAPHIC FACTORS

This area of segmentation targets customers’ interests, values, opinions, personality traits, attitudes, and preferences. Psychographic factors might include customers’ preferred mode of contact, whether they buy mainly organic produce, how often they give to charity, and which kinds of social media they use.

BEHAVIORAL FACTORS

Customers can be further segmented based on their shopping and purchasing behavior. For example, some may prefer direct contact with certain stores and services, while others may buy everything online. Customers may prefer to pay more for particular brands or shop around for special offers and discounts.

